

Please write clearly in block capitals.

Centre number

Candidate number

Surname

Forename(s)

A-level

ENVIRONMENTAL SCIENCE**Paper 2 (Generated practice paper - Set 06)**

Assessed: The living environment, Biological resources, Sustainability, Research methods

Time allowed: 3 hours**Materials**

For this paper you may use:

- a calculator.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen. Pencil should only be used for drawing.
- Fill in the boxes at the top of this page.
- Answer **all** questions 1 to 10 and **one** essay from question 11.
- You must answer the questions in the spaces provided. Do not write outside the box around each page or on blank pages.
- Do all rough work in this book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.

Information

- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- The maximum mark for this paper is 120.
- All questions should be answered in continuous prose.
- You will be assessed on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

For Examiner's Use

Question	Mark
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	
9	
10	
11	
TOTAL	

Answer all questions in the spaces provided.

0 1 . 1

Describe how each of the following abiotic factors can be managed to increase biodiversity in a nature reserve.

[6 marks]

Light

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Dissolved oxygen

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Nutrients

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0 1 . 2

Explain how biotic factors can be managed to increase the survival of a species. Give **four** examples.

[4 marks]

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10

0 2 . 1

Describe **four** ways in which the Wildlife and Countryside Act (1981) protects wildlife in the UK.

[4 marks]

1

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2

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3

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4

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0 2 . 2

Explain the difference between CITES Appendix I and Appendix II, giving an example species for each.

[4 marks]

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0 2 . 3

Explain why controlling international trade can be more effective than trying to stop collection of a species in its own country.

[2 marks]

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10

03 . 1

Explain why a moderate water shortage reduces crop productivity even though the plants survive.

[3 marks]

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03 . 2

Explain the problems caused by waterlogged soils and describe **two** ways farmers reduce soil water levels.

[4 marks]

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03 . 3

Explain how irrigating with groundwater can cause soil salinisation and how this harms crops.

[2 marks]

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03 . 4

State how a farmer could raise the pH of an acidic soil and explain why a low pH reduces fertility.

[1 mark]

.....

10

04 . 1 Describe the main principles of the circular economy.

[6 marks]

04 . 2 Explain what is meant by 'optimum production rather than maximum production', using a comparison between a natural ecosystem and an agroecosystem.

[2 marks]

04 . 3 Explain why international cooperation (eg through the EU or UN) is needed to implement circular economy initiatives.

[2 marks]

10

05 . 1

Explain how natural material cycles differ from linear human systems of material use.

[4 marks]

05 . 2

Explain why the use of toxic metals in electronic products is a particular problem for sustainability.

[2 marks]

05 . 3

Describe how the design of a product can move it from a linear to a cyclical system.

[4 marks]

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10

0 6 . 1

Which of the following features of a plantation would most increase its wildlife value? Tick one box.

[1 mark]

- A Close planting of a single non-indigenous species ☐
- B Mixed indigenous species with a mixed age structure ☐
- C Clear-felling on a 40-year rotation ☐
- D Removal of dead wood ☐

0 6 . 2

Describe **four** features of sustainably managed forests and explain how each benefits biodiversity or productivity.

[4 marks]

1

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2

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3

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4

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5

07 . 1

Describe **three** methods of reducing seabird by-catch in long-line fisheries.

[3 marks]

1

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2

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3

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07 . 2

Explain how restricting fishing effort and restricting fishing methods reduce overfishing.

[3 marks]

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07 . 3

Describe how captive rearing and release ('population seeding') can increase wild populations of lobsters or oysters.

[2 marks]

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07 . 4

Explain why collecting data on planktonic fish eggs and larvae helps to prevent population collapse.

[2 marks]

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10

08 . 1

Explain how overfishing of the giant triton mollusc damaged coral reefs in Australia.

[2 marks]

08 . 2

Describe **four** management practices used in marine protected areas to protect coral reefs.

[4 marks]

1

2

3

4

08 . 3

Explain why deep-water coral reefs recover much more slowly from trawling damage than tropical reefs.

[2 marks]

08 . 4

Give **two** threats to deep-water reefs and **one** conservation measure.

[2 marks]

10

09 . 1

Explain how each of the following changes in abiotic factors caused by human activities can make a habitat unsuitable for species living there.

[6 marks]**Water availability**

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Dissolved oxygen

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pH

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09 . 2

Explain how increased water turbidity caused by ploughing, mining or dredging harms aquatic organisms.

[2 marks]

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09 . 3

Explain why species that were already rare are most likely to be lost when abiotic conditions change.

[2 marks]

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10

10 . 1

Explain how an understanding of ecological succession and population dynamics can inform conservation decision-making.

[9 marks]

Extra space

10 . 2 State what is meant by a **taxon**.

[1 mark]

10

Write an essay on one of the following topics.

$$\boxed{1} \boxed{1} . \boxed{1}$$

Discuss how an understanding of energy flow and the manipulation of food species can be used to increase food production sustainably.

[25 marks]

OR

1 1 . 2

Using tropical coral reefs as an example, discuss how the ecological features of a habitat determine both its importance and its vulnerability to human activities.

[25 marks]

Indicate which question you have answered by writing its number, **11 . 1** or **11 . 2**, at the top of your answer.

[illegible]

END OF QUESTIONS